

MEMORANDUM / EMAIL (Verbatim — Local HR Professionals and Managers)

Subject line (email): Invitation to participate — HR Situational Judgment Test research study (Nicholls State University)

Dear [Name / Colleague],

You are invited to participate in a research study conducted at Nicholls State University:

Study title: HR Situational Judgment Test: Evidence-Based HR Decision-Making

Principal Investigator: Dr. Christopher M. Castille, Associate Professor

Department: Management and Marketing, Al Danos College of Business Administration

Email: christopher.castille@nicholls.edu

Phone: (337) 256-0664 or 985-449-7015

Purpose

This study compares how **HR professionals, managers, and students** evaluate the effectiveness of common HR management tactics in situational judgment scenarios. Your professional judgment provides an important benchmark for understanding evidence-based HR practice and improving HR education.

What participation involves

1. Open the study hub: <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hr-sjt-assessment/modular-surveys/>
2. Select a decision topic (or complete multiple short packs at your own pace).
3. Read and agree to the informed consent (if you choose to participate).
4. Enter your first and last name to generate a **Candidate ID** (your name is not stored with research data). Use the same name if you complete more than one pack.
5. Complete a brief **optional demographics** questionnaire (you may skip any item).
6. Rate HR tactics on a 1–5 scale (ratings are optional; you may skip any item).
7. Download a PDF summary of your ratings for your records (optional).

Time: About 5–15 minutes per short pack. You may complete one pack or several.

Voluntary participation

Participation is **VOLUNTARY**. You must be **18 years of age or older**. You may skip any question or rating, stop at any time, or decline without any consequence to your employment or relationship with the University.

Risks and benefits

Risks are minimal (time commitment; feedback may differ from your expectations). Benefits may include reflection on HR decision-making, a personal PDF summary of your ratings, and contributing to research that compares professional and student perspectives. There is **no monetary compensation**. As a token of appreciation, you may later receive an aggregated infographic of study findings (no individuals identified), if you opt in when offered.

Confidentiality

Your name is used only to generate a participant ID and is not stored with the research dataset. Data are reported only in aggregate or de-identified form.

Questions

Study questions: Dr. Christopher M. Castille (contact above).

Rights as a research participant: Nicholls State University Institutional Review Board (IRB).

Thank you for considering this invitation.

Sincerely,

Dr. Christopher M. Castille
Associate Professor, Management and Marketing
Al Danos College of Business Administration
Nicholls State University
christopher.castille@nicholls.edu

People Analytics Lab of the Bayou / Nicholls State University

Oral / in-person script (same content, spoken):

“I’m inviting local HR professionals and managers to complete a short online situational judgment survey for a Nicholls research study on evidence-based HR decision-making. It’s voluntary, about 5–15 minutes per topic, ages 18+, and you can skip any item. Here’s the link: <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hr-sjt-assessment/modular-surveys/> — I’m happy to email you this memo.”